WATCHMEN: VOL 1

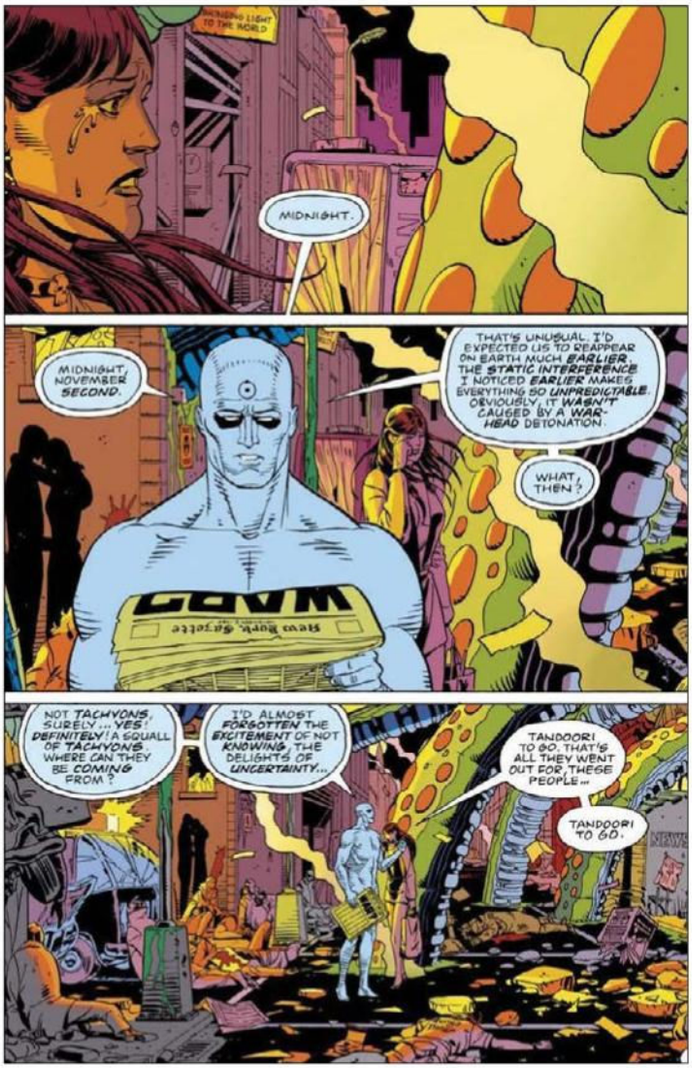
Details **Originally published** Watchmen #1-#12 (1986-87) **Publisher** DC Comics **Writer** Alan Moore
Artist Dave Gibbons **Collected in** Watchmen **Available digitally** Kindle, Comixology

Watchmen is undoubtedly a product of the Eighties. The then-current fear of nuclear war looms large, and, politically, the series is rooted deeply in its time. But the moral dilemmas the series poses, and the seedy lives of the 'heroes', are fresh as daisies. To this day, it still makes modern superhero comics look dated and simplistic.

In retrospect, the series is overshadowed by that brilliantly unbeatable twist ending and the awful inevitability of the fallout from it. It's easy to forget the well-executed soap opera of The Comedian, Sally and Laurie, or the sexual dysfunctions of the closest thing we have to a leading man, or the mind-bending omniscience of Doctor Manhattan.

It's often a surprise to re-read it and be reminded that *Watchmen* is laugh-out-loud funny in places. Quite simply, Alan Moore applied realism to costumed heroes, and practically overnight the whole genre changed forever.







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